



# FOSS Bytes

## Now, an Android module targets everyday appliances

San Francisco-based Touch Revolution has unveiled its new 'drop-in' NIM1000 module, which is designed to help OEMs integrate dynamic touch-screen interfaces in a broad range of appliances and devices, from microwave ovens and washing machines, to in-flight entertainment centres and advanced medical devices. The NIM1000 module includes a projective capacitive touch-screen and features the Android application framework, which makes it easy for manufacturers to add a myriad additional applications and services to their products. To demonstrate how the 'drop-in' NIM1000 module might transform next-generation appliances and devices, Touch Revolution showcased several potential products at CES 2010 in Las Vegas:



- A washing machine and dryer with simple, slider touch-screen controls to set wash and dry cycles and view progress. Online stain guides provide information on removing the toughest stains and those cryptic label wash symbols are decoded in a few touches.
- A microwave oven that doubles as a 'kitchen command centre' with Android running all kinds of useful applications: widgets for news and weather, a digital picture frame, Internet radio, recipes with video instructions, a Web browser and timers for each burner and the oven.

Yes, there was more, and if you let your imagination run wild, you should be able to come up with a few yourself.

## Moodbar and other custom labels back in Amarok 2.2.2

What's the difference between Amarok 2.2.2 and 2.2.1? If "Bug fix release," is your answer, then you're quite right. However, Amarok 2.2.2 also introduces some of the

features that were once available in the v1.4.x series of the media player, but were absent since v2.x made its debut. Here's quoting the announcement at the project home page: "...we focused on improvements and bug fixes, but let us remind you of the new features in this release first: The Custom Labels are back and allow you to add your personal touch to your music. Another new addition that will add quite some colour to your music experience: the moodbar makes its entry in the 2.2 series

so you can change the progress bar to fit with your current mood, be this normal, angry, frozen or just happy :)"

That's not all! There are a number of small, but useful improvements and feature additions that makes this version worth an upgrade.

## VMware to acquire Zimbra

VMware has announced that it has entered into a definitive agreement to acquire Zimbra, from Yahoo! The virtualisation giant claims this acquisition will further its mission of taking complexity out of the data centre, desktop, application development and core IT services, and delivering a fundamentally more efficient and new approach to IT.

Zimbra is a leading open source e-mail and collaboration solution with over 55 million mailboxes. As an independent Yahoo! product division, in 2009, Zimbra achieved a mailbox growth of 86 per cent overall and 165 per cent among small and medium business customers.

## BAE selects MontaVista over proprietary RTOS

The BAE Systems Bofors in Sweden has selected MontaVista Linux to power its new naval and artillery gun systems. The use of commercial quality embedded Linux provides for rapid development, combined with the long-term support required for military applications. "Military customers demand systems of the highest quality, and require support for extended lengths of time. At the same time, BAE needed a development environment that allowed us to rapidly deliver new systems to market to meet the needs of our customers," said Mikael Alfredsson, manager electronics and electrical design, BAE Systems Bofors. "By selecting MontaVista Linux we are able to achieve all these objectives — an open source operating system of the highest quality, rapid development, and long term support from Linux experts."

## Wipro joins the Open Handset Alliance

Wipro Technologies has joined the Open Handset Alliance, to extend its device development and service integration expertise around Android.

"Joining the Open Handset Alliance will help us turn around Android-based products and solutions faster with rich feature-sets," said Nagamani Murthy, vice president, Mobile, Automotive and Consumer Electronics Group, Wipro Technologies. "With most device vendors now releasing Android-based phones, we foresee an impressive growth on this platform. The Open Handset Alliance membership will enable us to satisfy the strong customer demand," she added.

